

CFO business-case pack

Contact Center AI Routing

Tenant: Apex Retail

Tenant key: apex-retail

Move ref: apex:move:contact-center-ai-routing

Generated: 2026-05-20

A one-document CFO pack — the seven-part answer standard: the answer, the case, the assumptions, what would make it wrong, what not to fund yet, what Tower will measure, the evidence and gaps.

Every figure in this document is produced by the Moves Expert Kernel from the tenant's audited substrate. Absent data is declared a seed gap, never invented. Effort rests on a researched planning rate card — a market range, not a quote. Generated by AbarVa · Moves.

CFO business-case pack — the seven-part answer

Contact Center AI Routing · apex-retail. This pack answers the CFO question to the spec §9 standard: not just an answer, but the case, the assumptions, the failure modes, the funding hold, the measurement handoff and the evidence.

1 · Here is the answer

Verdict: SHAPE — do not fund as-is

The critic raised 1 blocker(s) — fund only once they are resolved. Re-shape the Move to close them.

2 · Here is the business case

Investment (effort)	\$1,873,179 – \$3,085,236 (base \$2,203,740)
Net value (post-haircut)	\$8,282,820 – \$14,335,650 (base \$11,309,235)
Net return	\$5,197,584 – \$12,462,471 (base \$9,105,495)
Payback	Not monetisable — the value rests on a baseline seed gap, so the kernel returns no payback rather than a fabricated one.
Monetisable	No
AI-build effort	\$1,694,000
Business-change effort	\$509,740 (23% of effort)

Scenario	Investment	Net return	ROI
Base	\$2,203,740	\$9,105,495	Not recorded — seed gap
Conservative	\$3,085,236	\$5,197,584	Not recorded — seed gap
Upside	\$1,873,179	\$12,462,471	Not recorded — seed gap

Downside read: The conservative case cannot be expressed in hard dollars — the value rests on a seed-gap proxy. Close the baseline gap before reading the downside as a number.

3 · Here are the assumptions driving it

The three flagged TOP MOVERS move roughly 80% of the outcome.

- [TOP MOVER] [SEED-GAP PROXY] annual_contact_volume — Annual agent-handled contact volume is ~9.0M (benchmark for an \$80B retailer) — used only to express value in operational hours. (owner Priya Iyer (Program Lead); confidence low; impact high)
- [TOP MOVER] [SEED-GAP PROXY] cost_per_contact — Fully-loaded cost per contact is ~\$6.50 (benchmark proxy) until the tenant baseline due 2026-05-15 lands. (owner Brendan Fox (CS Ops); confidence low; impact high)
- [TOP MOVER] containment_uplift — AI routing lifts containment ~12 points (28% ' 40% target) — the KPI dictionary states this uplift target explicitly. (owner Priya Iyer (Program Lead); confidence medium; impact high)
- adoption_ramp — Customer Care agents reach 70% steady-state adoption by year 2; the WFM lead is on record preferring agent-assist over IVR replacement. (owner Mariana Rojas (WFM Lead); confidence medium; impact medium)
- privacy_gate_clears — The transcript-use privacy review (2026-05-17 milestone) clears without scope cuts that remove agent-assist features. (owner Elena Fischer (AI Governance); confidence medium; impact medium)
- rate_card — Blended delivery rate card reflects market rates for AI build and integration roles. (owner David Okafor (Program Lead); confidence medium; impact low)

4 · Here is what would make me wrong

The case breaks if the baseline seed gap is not closed — without the missing unit economics the value range is a proxy, not a forecast.

- [blocker/cfo] cfo_monetisation_blocked: Value cannot be monetised to a hard dollar figure — the gross value range rests on a seed-gap proxy. The CFO will not approve a fabricated return; the case must close the baseline gap first.
- [concern/data] data_baseline_seed_gaps: 4 baseline metric(s) are seed gaps (coverage 60%): Cost per contact (labour), Annual contact volume, Channel mix (voice/chat/IVR split), QA error rate. The case is grounded only on what is recorded.
- [concern/data] data_top_mover_is_proxy: 2 of the top-3 case-moving assumptions stand in for absent tenant data (annual_contact_volume, cost_per_contact). Validating these is the highest-leverage next step.

5 · Here is what I would not fund until fixed

- kill_downside_negative: Net return is negative in the conservative case (5197584). Kill or re-shape if the downside cannot be lifted above zero.
- kill_monetisation_unresolved: The baseline seed gap that blocks monetisation is not closed before the gate — without it the return is unverifiable.
- kill_baseline_unclosed: Baseline coverage stays below acceptable level — 4 seed gap(s) remain unresolved at the gate.
- kill_privacy_gate_blocks: The 2026-05-17 transcript-use privacy review fails and removes agent-assist features — the value case loses its core mechanism.

Surfaced structural flags:

-

[critic/blocker] Value cannot be monetised to a hard dollar figure — the gross value range rests on a seed-gap proxy. The CFO will not approve a fabricated return; the case must close the baseline gap first.

- [critic/concern] 4 baseline metric(s) are seed gaps (coverage 60%): Cost per contact (labour), Annual contact volume, Channel mix (voice/chat/IVR split), QA error rate. The case is grounded only on what is recorded.
- [critic/concern] 2 of the top-3 case-moving assumptions stand in for absent tenant data (annual_contact_volume, cost_per_contact). Validating these is the highest-leverage next step.

6 · Here is what Tower will measure later

3 of 4 metric(s) are wired to a recorded baseline (coverage 75%). Value loop closes: NO.

Metric	Baseline	Target	Cadence
Contact Center Containment	28	40	monthly
Average Handle Time	7.2	6.5	monthly
CSAT (post-interaction)	4.1	4.4	quarterly
Cost per contact (labour)	Not recorded — seed gap	Not recorded — seed gap	monthly

7 · Here is the evidence I used — and what is missing

Baseline coverage 60%. 6 recorded metric(s), each with a cited source:

Metric	Value	Source	Quality
Average Handle Time	7.2 minutes	KPI kpi:apex:019 (NICE CXone)	measured/high
Contact Center Containment	28 percent	KPI kpi:apex:018 (NICE CXone)	measured/medium
First Call Resolution	68 percent	KPI kpi:apex:020 (NICE CXone)	measured/medium
Agent Utilization	84 percent	KPI kpi:apex:021 (NICE CXone)	measured/high
CSAT (post-interaction)	4.1 score_out_of_5	KPI kpi:apex:012 (Zendesk survey)	measured/medium
Repeat transfer rate	18.4 percent	Move P2 baseline deliverable (Genesys routing export)	measured/medium
Cost per contact (labour)	Not recorded — seed gap	seed gap	absent/low
Annual contact volume	Not recorded — seed gap	seed gap	absent/low
Channel mix (voice/chat/IVR split)	Not recorded — seed gap	seed gap	absent/low
QA error rate	Not recorded — seed gap	seed gap	absent/low

Declared seed gaps — missing, never invented:

•

Cost per contact (labour): Not recorded. Tenant action item "Capture cost-per-contact baseline" (owner Brendan Fox) is due 2026-05-15 — see operating telemetry.

- Annual contact volume: Not recorded in the KPI dictionary, telemetry, or the Move baseline. Needed to convert AHT/containment deltas into FTE-hours and dollars.
- Channel mix (voice/chat/IVR split): Containment note references "IVR + chatbot" but no structured split is seeded.
- QA error rate: No contact-centre quality-defect metric is seeded for Apex.

Every figure in this document is produced by the Moves Expert Kernel from the tenant's audited substrate. Absent data is declared a seed gap, never invented. Effort rests on a researched planning rate card — a market range, not a quote. Generated by AbarVa · Moves.